UGONNA EZENEKWE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a Sociology with Criminology graduate moving into cyber security and IT, and most of my experience comes from hands on project work. I have audited controls against NIST CSF, PCI DSS and UK GDPR, built a Splunk and Ubuntu lab to triage alerts and analyse network traffic, and used SQL to investigate login and device records. I am now completing the Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate while working in a customer facing role at Co-op. My degree taught me to look at behaviour, process and risk rather than technology alone, and that is the perspective I want to bring to a graduate role or internship in security operations, governance and risk, or wider IT.

KEY SKILLS

Governance, Risk and Compliance: Control gap analysis, risk assessment and risk registers, audit reporting, remediation roadmaps, third party risk, NIST CSF 2.0, ISO/IEC 27001:2022, PCI DSS, UK GDPR, Cyber Essentials

Security Operations and Technical: SIEM alert triage (Splunk, Wazuh), NIST incident response, log and packet analysis (Wireshark, tcpdump), SQL (MariaDB: filtering, joins, login analysis), Linux command line (Ubuntu), Python, Excel (lookups, pivot tables)

Professional: Report writing and documentation, stakeholder communication, reporting to senior managers, customer service, working under pressure, time management, teamwork

PROJECTS

Security Control and Compliance Audits | Independent — May 2026 – Present

- Conducted end to end internal audits of two simulated organisations in retail and healthcare, assessed against PCI DSS, UK GDPR and NIST CSF, covering asset inventory, control gaps and risk register development.
- Identified critical gaps including absent least privilege access, unencrypted customer data and no disaster recovery plan, rating each risk by likelihood and impact.
- Delivered audit reports and remediation roadmaps with prioritised findings for technical and non-technical readers.

SQL for Security Investigations | Independent — Nov 2026

- Queried login and device records in MariaDB, isolating 19 failed after hours logins consistent with password guessing.
- Used inner, left and right joins to reconcile machine and employee tables, finding 15 devices with no assigned owner, and published each lab with queries and findings on GitHub.

Home SOC Lab (Splunk / Ubuntu) | Independent — May 2026 – Present

- Built an Ubuntu lab running Splunk and tcpdump, provisioning VMs and fixing boot and configuration failures.
- Triaged alerts across simulated brute force, ransomware, phishing and data exfiltration incidents, applying the NIST incident response lifecycle to document detection and containment.
- Analysed traffic with Wireshark and tcpdump to trace a SYN and ICMP flood to a single source IP and a misconfigured firewall, then recommended rate limiting and IDS/IPS deployment.

SOC Analyst Simulation Training (SOCSimulator / LetsDefend) | Independent — Jun 2026 – Present

- Handled 30 alerts in five minutes across SIEM, XDR and firewall consoles, prioritising by severity and correlating events into attack narratives and case reports.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Customer Team Member | Co-op — Dec 2025 – Present

- Handle several thousand pounds in daily transactions, working accurately at pace through peak trading periods.
- First point of contact on the shop floor, resolving queries, complaints and payment issues to store procedure and escalating to a duty manager where a case needs sign off.

Customer Assistant | Tesco — Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

- Operated tills through peak hours, handling transactions and resolving customer queries calmly under pressure.
- Rotated fresh food stock by date and supported deliveries, improving inventory accuracy and reducing waste.

Justice Research and Communications Intern | Reimagining Criminal Justice C.I.C. — Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Managed a stakeholder database of over 50 national and international organisations, keeping records accurate and retrievable for senior staff.
- Produced concise summaries of complex documents for senior decision makers and drafted outreach to partner organisations to the organisation’s sign off requirements.

Summer Playscheme Volunteer | CARIS Haringey — Jul 2022 – Aug 2024

- Supported vulnerable families with housing applications, benefits and essential services, guiding them through complex systems when the stakes were high.
- Coordinated children’s activities, adapting plans on the spot while keeping a calm, organised presence.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BSc Sociology with Criminology | Middlesex University – First Class

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate | Coursera – In progress, 4 of 8 courses complete